test = 1. (*logic*) any criterion or procedure used to determine the truth or falsity of a hypothesis, either by empirical evidence or by reasoning; 2. (*psychol.*) a routine examination administered to individuals belonging to the same group, in order to determine the relative position of a given individual in the group with respect to one or more mental traits, motor abilities, etc. or in order to compare one group with another in these characteristics. [In practice a series or battery of psychological tests (2) is generally used, and the scores are arranged or plotted on a definite scale; cf. **mental test**, **scale** (1).] **tester**^{np} (contr. rarely w. **testee**, the individual tested). — Fr. (1) *épreuve*, (2) *test*; Ger. (1) *Prüfung*, (2) *Test*, *Probe*.